

Smartphones to drive analogue IC market

Technologies essential to the latest smartphones and tablets mean that the analogue integrated circuit (IC) industry can look forward to guaranteed expansion over the next few years—according to a report by GBI Research.

Analogue ICs are used in a wide range of applications including third- and fourth-generation (3G/4G) radio base stations and portable device batteries, as well as medical imaging scanners and electric cars.

GBI Research predicts that the sales revenue from the general-purpose analogue IC industry, responsible for the production of amplifiers and voltage regulators, will grow from a 2012 value of \$20.41 billion at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of approximately 9 per cent to \$31.35 billion by the end of 2016.

The application-specific analogue



HTC One smartphone

Sony India appoints new MD

The current managing director of Sony India, Masaru Tamagawa, will be the new president of Sony Europe and Kenichiro Hibi will replace him as the new managing director of Sony India.

As the MD of Sony India, Hibi will be responsible for spearheading the overall growth and profitability of the company within the region.

Nokia appoints VP and MD, India

Nokia India has appointed P. Balaji as the vice president and managing director for the India region. In this role, Balaji will be responsible for growing Nokia's mobile phones and smart devices business in India while providing strategic direction and operational focus. Besides building and consolidating Nokia's market presence, Balaji will focus on engendering the Nokia brand, driving partnerships and strategic alliances, and developing the capabilities of the Nokia organisation in India.

Lenovo India names new executive director

Lenovo India has appointed Sudipto Ghosh as the executive director for service and support. In this role, Ghosh will lead customer service, steering the contact

centre, field service, service business and customer delight functions for Lenovo India.

Sudipto will develop end-to-end customer service and support across the three business segments of consumer, relational and SMB.

Agilent appoints new country manager

Agilent Technologies has appointed Sudhir Tangri as the new country manager for the electronics measurement group of Agilent Technologies India. Prior to this appointment, Tangri was the vice president and head of sales at Symphony Teleca Corporation.

Tewari is director of Canon India's CSP Group

Canon India has appointed Rajeev Tewari as the director of CSP group. In this new role, Tewari would look at taking CSP's growth to the next level and increasing the contribution to Canon's overall brand revenue.

Prior to taking this role, Tewari headed the wide-format imaging division where he successfully set up the marketing and sales operation of the division. He has replaced V.P. Sajeevan, who led the CSP group for over five years.

IC industry, which makes power management and communications chips, is expected to increase its sales revenue from \$27.47 billion in 2012 to \$38.15 billion in 2016, climbing at a CAGR of 6.8 per cent.

GBI Research anticipates smartphone sales to play a major role in the expansion of the overall analogue IC market. Last year, the number of smartphones in use was over 417 million—a staggering figure that is expected to grow further to just under one billion by 2016.

600 million smartphones with gesture recognition by 2017

ABI Research forecasts that 600 million smartphones will be shipped

with vision-based gesture recognition features in 2017.

Gesture recognition is a very exciting prospect, particularly for smartphones and tablets. Says Josh Flood, senior analyst at ABI Research, "These devices are already heavily entrenched into our lives and another communication interface is always very welcome."

Qualcomm is heavily promoting its Snapdragon chipset processors powered vision-based gesture recognition technology in 2012. Intel has primarily focused upon touch capabilities for its notebooks and ultrabooks this year. Nevertheless, the company's senior management has acknowledged gesture and voice

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